

MARKETING GOALS

1M

Waitlist Users (Global)
Growth owns · Mktg contributes 20%+

500K

SME Pipeline (within 2mo of waitlist)
CFO Summit + Offline (Isham) + Direct Network

1M

Social Followers
Benchmark Revolut · Beat WIO · LI-first

20%+

Mktg Contribution to Growth
Every \$ ties to a measurable metric

CBUAE

License (Expected Sep 2026)
AAS = regulator POC · Contingency Nov 1

18

Markets at Wave 1
USD/ACH global · AED = UAE only

POSITIONING — HOW WE TALK ABOUT MAL (PRIORITY ORDER)

P0 — LEAD WITH THIS

Licensed Financial Institution

"Clearly a bank — a full bank with a license"

Not a wrapper, not a prepaid card, not an EMI. Always the first thing we say.

P1 — DIFFERENTIATOR

AI-Native Banking

"Open an account in 30 seconds"

AI is not a feature. The entire bank is built on it.

P2 — CHERRY ON TOP

Islamic & Shariah-Compliant

"Ethical banking as the added value layer"

Built in, not bolted on. Earns trust without narrowing the audience.

Global vs UAE: Mal (global) ≠ Mal Bank (UAE/CBUAE). AAS = POC for Public Affairs.

Moat: "Only moat is user-base; everything else is replicable." Must be quantitative.

Messaging: No generic claims. Only flex real experiences. Be quantitative or stay quiet.

OWNERSHIP MATRIX

BUDGET ALLOCATION

GROWTH — 80%

BRAND & MKTG — 20%

Budget: Amine · Growth strategy: Mukund · Hiring: Sama

DOMAIN	OWNER	SCOPE
Growth	Mukund	Userbase, retention, referral, acquisition (80%)
Marketing	Manar, Yasmeen, Isham	Brand, PR, influencers, events, social, TOV, content
Sales / SME	SME Team + Isham	Offline onboarding, CFO Summit, distribution
Product	David, VK, Manar	Demos, tech comms, launches
Public Affairs	AAS	CBUAE comms (UAE-only)
Compliance	Maen + Walid	Risk, regulatory readiness
Hiring	Sama	Marketing team hiring plan
Budgets	Amine	Budget allocation & approval

Rule: Mktg does NOT own growth metrics but must contribute 20%+. Referral program owned by Growth.

INCENTIVE STRATEGY BY SEGMENT

SEGMENT	HOOK	INCENTIVE	PRODUCT ANGLE	CHANNEL
Window Shoppers	"Join waitlist, get paid"	Cash for signup; share LI/IG/X → \$X	Waitlist virality	Social, Paid LI
Adopters	"Try the tech first"	Founder Card + 1-yr sub + beta + community	UI, speed, process	LI Thought Leaders
Retail	"Never need SWIFT again"	Global Accounts first (USD/ACH); 4x salary	Expats EG/TR/IN/PK; lending later (Wave 2–3)	Partnerships, Digital
SMEs	"Upload paperwork — eligible in seconds"	AED 300K at 5%; Mal pays your bills	Bank + Lender one-stop	CFO Summit, Offline

Competitive Stack: FAB = large SMEs, no lending. WIO = tiny SMEs. EFG = lender not bank. **Mal = Bank + Lender. One-stop.**

WAITLIST FUNNEL & GUARDRAILS

Email Only — Weak intent

Email + KYC — Interest

KYC + Referrals — Engagement

Completes Loans — IDEAL

KYC may not be live at waitlist launch. Until active, waitlist is hype-only. Focus on positioning: licensed bank, AI-native, Shariah-compliant.

GUARDRAIL	RATIONALE
Clients ≠ Partners	Closes doors (ADNOC = client)
No generic claims	Be quantitative or stay quiet
Mal ≠ Mal Bank	CBUAE only cares about UAE
Only real experiences	"2 seconds" not "we're fast"
90% revenue = lending	Banking acquires, lending generates

WAITLIST HYPE PLAYBOOK

► 10-20 influencers (LI primary, explore IG/X/other platforms)

► Isham identifies influencers & groups per platform with 3rd-party agency

► "UI is great, credit limit in 30 seconds"

► CTA: "I just joined the Mal waitlist and I have 5 slots to give"

► Share to LI/IG/X → get \$X free (package TBD)

► Benchmarks: Revolut, Clubhouse waitlist models

5 Hype Pillars

UI excellenceAuthentically IslamicProduct speedReferral + Founder CardPrivate community

CFO SUMMIT & LAUNCH EVENT

CFO Summit

► Top CFOs in ME, 50 max, private round table

► 2-3 VIP speakers (e.g., Hazem)

► "Where are you facing issues with your existing bank?"

► Capture: company info, employees, distribution

► "Mal pays your bills — onboard your vendors"

Media Training

AmineDavidVKZigorMaen+WalidYoussef

2nd line: Talga, Rideu, Izz

BRAND DNA (TO DEFINE)

Foundation

► TOV · Brand Architecture · Targets (not personas) · Assets (decks, attire, gifting) · Internal AI for corporate comms

Owned Media

► LI (primary), IG, X · Events · PR · McKinsey papers · Private community (beta)

PRODUCT SUITE ROADMAP

	Jun 2026 NOW	Jul 2026 NEXT · WAVE 1	Aug 2026	Sep 2026	Oct 2026 WAVE 2	Nov–Dec 2026 WAVE 3	2027 WAVE 4
RETAIL BANKING	USD Account USD Card USD Payout ...	WAVE 1 LIVE 18 markets · Global Accounts		AED Account AED Card AED Payout UAE only	WAVE 2 LIVE UAE (post-license)	Credit Card	
SME BANKING	SME USD Account SME USD Card SME USD Payout			SME AED Account SME AED Card SME AED Payout UAE only			
LENDING & FINANCING			Invoice Factoring SME · dev Jul	Personal Financing Auto Financing SME Financing dev Sep		IVF Financing Tuition Financing dev Aug–Sep	
AI AGENTS	PFM Agent dev Jun						Travel Agent Tax Agent Accounting Agent Shopping Agent CFO Agent
Wave 1 (Jul '26): 8 products · 18 markets · + 15 more Wave 2 (Oct '26): 10 products · UAE only Wave 3 (Nov–Dec '26): 3 products · Wave 4 (2027): 5 AI Agents							

MARKETING ROADMAP — PHASES, LICENSING & EVENTS

	Jun 2026 NOW	Jul 2026 NEXT	Aug 2026	Sep 2026	Oct 2026	Nov–Dec 2026	2027
MARKETING PHASES	Phase 1: Plumbing Internal QA, stress testing, no external comms	Phase 2: Waitlist Hype (Pre-Launch) 5 Hype Pillars · 20-30 influencers (LI, IG/X) · Isham + agency · Referral + Founder Card			Grand Launch Oct 10 (contingency Nov 11)	Scale · Paid acquisition · Lending comms	
LAUNCH COMMS		ACH Launch Comms (Wave 1) "Never need SWIFT again" · Target: EG · TR · IN · PK expats			AED Launch Comms (Wave 2) UAE · Post-license messaging	Lending product comms (IVF, Tuition, Credit Card)	
LICENSING & EVENTS				CBUAE License Expected. If delayed → Nov 1	Launch Event Oct 10 or Nov 11		CFO Summit 50 pax · TBD within first year

IMMEDIATE ACTION ITEMS				
#	OWNER(S)	ACTION	PRIORITY	STATUS
1	AAS + Walid	Roadmap + product suite sign-off, share with team	URGENT	FINAL STAGES
2	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm marketing strategy, roles & incentive strategy	URGENT	PENDING
3	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm CFO Summit + Launch Event (Oct 10 / contingency Nov 11)	URGENT	PENDING
4	Manar	Budget allocations: marketing, brand, sales, growth (Amine approves)	HIGH	PENDING
5	Yasmeen + Walid	Schedule calls between Manar and GA team vs other product leads	HIGH	IN PROGRESS
6	Isham (lead) + Yasmeen (content)	Define waitlist referral package (share to LI/IG/X → \$X reward)	HIGH	PENDING
7	Isham + 3rd-party agency	Identify 10-20 influencers & groups per platform for paid hype	HIGH	PENDING
8	Marketing Team	Get to 1M waitlist users (incentive + ACH/USD — excl. sanctioned markets)	HIGH	PENDING
9	Marketing Team	Internal corporate comms + assets (brand DNA, gifting, decks, attire)	MEDIUM	PENDING
10	Mukund	Growth budget request strategy (Amine = budget holder)	MEDIUM	PENDING
11	Walid	Draft and document marketing roadmap, then meet to align	MEDIUM	PENDING
12	Sama / Amine	Hiring plan for marketing team (Sama = hiring, Amine = budget)	MEDIUM	PENDING
CRITICAL PATH				
Plumbing (Jun) → Waitlist Hype → Wave 1 USD (Jul) → Invoice Factoring (Aug) → License (Sep) → Launch Event + Wave 2 (Oct) → Wave 3 (Nov–Dec) → AI Agents (2027)				
25 products · 4 waves · 18 markets Confidential · Internal use only				